Adam R. **Rohde**

Oakland, California

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Profile

PhD in Statistics | Causal Inference | 9+ Years of Experience

Results-driven data science leader driving product strategy in two-sided marketplace. Thought partner to product and engineering leadership, framing ship decisions and roadmap priorities across recommendations ecosystem. Redesigned the company's in house A/B testing engine (org wide default); established org wide A/B testing standards; conducts decision oriented causal and Bayesian analyses.

Skills

Methods Experimentation; Causal Inference; Bayesian Modeling; Econometrics; ML

Tools Python; SQL; Spark; R; Databricks; Statsig; Git

Professional

ZipRecruiter *Oakland & Santa Monica, CA*

Decision Science Manager (2025-); Tech Lead (2024-2025); Senior Decision Scientist (2023-2024) *2023 - Present*

Lead analytics for recommendations ecosystem in two-sided marketplace matching job seekers and employers. Manage team of 2 (soon to be 4).

- Led evaluation and rollout strategy for the core candidate-ranking model used to surface job seekers to employers: designed the A/B test portfolio across surfaces and model variants balancing employer signals against job seeker signals, analyzed results, and framed tradeoffs and recommendations for VPs of Product over six months of testing. Shipped model de-emphasizing job seeker willingness to apply, which decreased applications while driving +10% increase employer outreach to candidates and lift in employer satisfaction.
- Led the analytics workstream for "Objective Match," a VP-sponsored initiative aligning recommendations with employer hiring criteria via automated LLM generated screening question suggestions. Drove product thought partnership and ship decisions; defined the impact framework laddering application quality and volume to revenue and retention. Presented progress twice weekly to VPs and broader group. Produced clear lift in application quality but modest non-significant lift in revenue. Adoption exceeded 90% of employers. Live workstream.
- Redesigned the company's Bayesian A/B testing engine from an undocumented approximation to a principled empirical Bayes hierarchical model with partial pooling; achieved 10,000× speedup by eliminating per sample posterior operations. Adopted org wide as the default A/B testing engine.
- Quantified potential impact of prioritizing recommendations by candidate qualification rather than engagement alone. Built a Bayesian hierarchical logistic regression at the job recommendation level (10M job recommendation across 1M email sends) with random effects per email; used ADVI for posterior approximation (MCMC infeasible at scale) and Monte Carlo simulation for impact uncertainty. Counterfactual simulation projected 5%+ lift in applications and unique appliers. Validation test is on our roadmap.
- Sized previously-unused job seeker activity signals (e.g., SEO page views) as inputs to learning core job seeker embeddings, identifying potential double digit growth in applications. Live workstream.
- Additional Org Wide Influence: Drove the org's methodological transition from Bayesian to frequentist experimentation, shaping Statsig adoption strategy. Led initiative building automated KPI alerting for job seeker org. Built Bayesian CUPED variance-reduction tooling; demonstrated equal allocation across arms in multi-variant tests is suboptimal for non-skewed metrics and shipped optimal-allocation tool. Led learning sessions across the org on CUPED, empirical Bayes, instrumental variables, regression discontinuity designs, and mediation analysis; authored internal reference compendium of common experimentation pitfalls synthesized from cross-team surveys.

Twitter *Los Angeles, CA*

Researcher *2022*

- Designed and analyzed a randomized holdout experiment measuring differential algorithmic amplification of elected officials across U.S. political parties. Found that both Republican and Democrat legislators enjoy positive algorithmic amplification. Algorithmic amplification tracks developments in political events. Presented findings internally company wide.

Charles River Associates *Oakland, CA & Boston, MA*

Consulting Associate (2015-2019); Associate (2014-2015); Analyst (2012-2014) *2012 - 2019*

- Led econometric analyses of marketplace dynamics including pricing, competition, and demand for high-stakes M&A and antitrust matters across retail, healthcare, industrial manufacturing, and commodity industries. Managed analyst teams; presented to senior executives and counsel.

Education

UCLA PhD, Statistics | 2019-2023 | Methods for sample selection bias and sensitivity analysis

Boston College BA, Mathematics and Economics | 2009-2013 | Giffuni Prize; Honors in Economics

Publications & Open Source

Rohde & Hazlett (R&R at JRSS-A). Causal progress with imperfect placebo treatments and outcomes. | PlaceboLM R package (github.com/adam-rohde/PlaceboLM) | Rohde (2023). Selection into the Sample and into Treatment. UCLA. | Rohde & Murphy (2018). Rational Bias in Inflation Expectations, Eastern Econ Journal.